

Comprehensive Series Outline

1. Subjects/Topics to Cover

- **Core Focus:**
 - **Puberty Education:** Physical changes (body hair, growth spurts, menstruation), emotional shifts (mood swings, crushes), and social dynamics (friendships, bullying).
 - **Life Skills:** Hygiene, digital literacy, self-care, critical thinking (myth vs. fact), and consent.
- **Integrated Subjects:**
 - **Science:** Biology of puberty (hormones, reproductive systems), anatomy, mental health basics.
 - **Social Studies:** Cultural traditions around puberty (e.g., coming-of-age rituals, diverse family structures).
 - **Arts:** Creative self-expression (Emma's vlogs, Jada's humor, Mia's letters).
 - **Media Literacy:** Analyzing beauty standards, social media safety.
- **Example Integration:**
 - Book 11 (*Period Power*) blending biology (menstrual cycles) with cultural studies (global period traditions).

2. Tone & Style

- **Tone:**
 - **Relatable & Empowering:** Honest about awkwardness but never shameful.
 - **Humorous & Heartfelt:** Use Jada's daydreams for comic relief and Mia's letters for emotional depth.
 - **Adventurous:** Frame puberty as a "quest" (e.g., treehouse discoveries, community missions).
- **Style:**
 - **Conversational:** As if the girls are talking directly to the reader.
 - **Interactive:** Include quizzes, journal prompts, and DIY activities (e.g., "Build Your Self-Care Kit").
 - **Multimedia:** Mimic Emma's vlogs, Ivy's infographics, and text message snippets.

3. Themes & Messages

- **Core Themes:**

- **Self-Acceptance:** “Your body is not a problem to solve.”
- **Friendship as Power:** Collaboration > competition.
- **Resilience:** Messiness is part of growth.
- **Inclusivity:** All bodies and identities are valid.
- **Subtler Messages:**
 - **Critical Thinking:** Question societal norms (e.g., “Why *shouldn’t* we talk about periods?”).
 - **Intergenerational Wisdom:** Mema Hazel and community elders model guidance without judgment.
 - **Advocacy:** Use Kayla/Sophie’s redemption to show growth > perfection.
- **Example:**
 - Book 9 (*Body Image Brilliance*) critiquing airbrushed beauty standards while celebrating diverse role models.

4. Main Characters

- **Character Archetypes:**

Character	Personality	Storytelling Tool	Growth Arc
Mia	Anxious, loyal, reflective	“Dear Mema Hazel” letters	Finds courage to lead.
Emma	Creative, emotional, artsy	Vlogs/art	Balances creativity with confidence.
Jada	Humorous, imaginative, chaotic	Daydreams/comedy skits	Learns vulnerability isn’t weakness.
Ivy	Logical, curious, reserved	Mystery Journal/checklists	Embraces emotional connections.

Diversity Notes:

- Varied family structures (e.g., Mia’s multigenerational bakery family, Ivy’s immigrant parents).
- Include neurodiversity (e.g., Ivy as neurodivergent-coded, Jada with ADHD energy).

5. Inspirational Models & Comparative Analysis

- **Series to Emulate:**

- **The Baby-Sitters Club:** Episodic storytelling with rotating character focus.
- **Guts / Smile (Raina Telgemeier):** Graphic novel-style honesty about puberty.
- **The Confidence Code for Girls:** Interactive, empowering nonfiction.
- **The Vanderbeekers:** Wholesome community-centered adventures.
- **Comparison with Georgia Nicholson:**
 - **Humor and Voice:** Utilize Jada's imaginative daydreams similar to Georgia's witty, self-deprecating humor.
 - **Relatability and Voice-Driven Narrative:** Mirror the first-person intimacy seen in Georgia's narrative, using diverse POV such as Mia's letters and Emma's vlogs.
 - **Educational Focus and Inclusivity:** While maintaining humor, integrate educational content about puberty and embrace a broader representation of diverse experiences.
- **Unique Twist:**
 - Merging the practicality of a puberty guide with the heart of a friendship saga using the treehouse journal as a narrative throughline.

1. Target Audience

Age Range: 10-13 years old (grades 5-8)

- **Why This Range?**
 - 10-11: Preteens experiencing early puberty (e.g., first periods, body changes).
 - 12-13: Teens navigating social dynamics, crushes, and self-esteem.
- **Content Adjustments:**
 - Use age-appropriate language (e.g., "private parts" instead of clinical terms).
 - Balance humor with sensitivity to avoid alienating younger readers.
 - Include diverse experiences to reflect a wide range of puberty timelines.

Example:

- Book 1 (Puberty Jungle) could focus on early changes (e.g., body hair, growth spurts) to engage younger readers, while Book 8 (Crush Confidential) tackles romantic feelings for older readers.

2. Series Length

Proposed Structure: 14 books (as outlined in your plan).

- **Why 14?**
 - Each book can focus on a specific puberty topic (e.g., body image, periods, hygiene).
 - Allows for character growth and antagonist redemption (Kayla/Sophie).
 - Provides space to explore recurring motifs (community connections).

Pacing:

- Books 1-3: Establish the group, introduce puberty basics, and set up the meeting place(s).
 - Books 4-8: Tackle practical challenges (e.g., body hair, bras, crushes) while deepening friendships.
 - Books 9-13: Address societal pressures (e.g., social media, self-care) and resolve lingering conflicts.
 - Book 14: Culmination
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3. Narrative Style

Primary Style: Prose with integrated multimedia elements.

- **Why Prose?**
 - Allows for deeper character development and emotional resonance.
 - Fits the diary/letter format (Mia's letters, Ivy's journal).

Multimedia Integration:

- Emma's Vlogs: Include script excerpts or illustrated storyboards.
- Ivy's Journal: Feature infographics, checklists, and diagrams.
- Jada's Daydreams: Use comic-style illustrations for her exaggerated scenarios.
- Interactive Elements: Add QR codes linking to printable guides (e.g., period trackers, self-care kits).

Example:

- Book 11 (Period Power) could include a menstrual cycle infographic in Ivy's journal and a vlog script from Emma about period myths.
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4. Sensitivity Readers

Why Sensitivity Readers?

- Ensure authentic representation of diverse experiences (e.g., cultural traditions, disabilities).
- Avoid harmful stereotypes or inadvertent exclusion.
- Build trust with readers and parents.

Areas to Address:

- Cultural Traditions: Include diverse coming-of-age rituals (e.g., quinceañeras, moon ceremonies).
- Body Diversity: Represent different body types, abilities, and skin tones in illustrations and descriptions.

How to Find Sensitivity Readers:

- Partner with educators, pediatricians, and community organizations.
 - Hire professional sensitivity readers (e.g., through platforms like Writing Diversely or Editors of Color).
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5. Marketing Angle

Tagline Ideas:

- "Growing up is messy. Let's figure it out together."
- "Puberty, friendship, and a treehouse full of secrets."
- "Your survival guide to middle school—with laughs, heart, and a little glitter."

Hook:

- Still deciding (TBD)

Marketing Strategies:

- Social Media Campaigns: Share character quotes, interactive quizzes, and behind-the-scenes content (e.g., "How to Make a Period Emergency Kit").
- School Visits: Partner with middle schools to host puberty workshops or book clubs.
- Merchandise: Create journal kits, self-care boxes, or treehouse-themed notebooks.